European Commission

Joint Research Centre



DigComp 3.0 Information Leaflet

European Digital Competence Framework – fifth edition

2025

HIGHLIGHTS

- This **information leaflet** describes what the European Digital Competence Framework (DigComp) is, who it is for, and how it is used.
- It explains **why and how** the fifth iteration, **DigComp 3.0**, **was developed**.
- It describes the **main components of DigComp 3.0** – the definition of digital competence, competence areas, competences, proficiency levels, learning outcomes, and the integration of AI competence.
- It also includes links to **further information** on DigComp.

Digital environments are deeply intertwined with daily life, working, learning, and participation in society. Individuals need to be digitally competent to benefit from the possibilities offered by digital technologies as well as the challenges that they can bring. Yet, in 2023, only 56% of adults in the EU had above basic digital skills, and 43% of secondary school students in the EU did not reach a basic level of digital skills.

The **DigComp framework** plays an **important role** in the EU's efforts to address digital skills gaps.

More information on DigComp:

Go to the full version of the DigComp 3.0 framework **or visit the** JRC-DigComp website.

Find out about the various ways in which DigComp is used in this short report.

What is the European Digital Competence Framework, DigComp?

The **European Digital Competence Framework (DigComp)** describes what is needed to be digitally competent in today's society. It supports the development of digital competence among individuals of all ages. The framework covers a wide range of digital skills levels, from basic to highly advanced, and offers a **stable reference point** in a rapidly evolving digital technological landscape.

DigComp is developed by the European Commission's Joint Research Centre (JRC), in collaboration with the Directorate-General for Employment, Social Affairs and Inclusion (DG EMPL).

DigComp 3.0 (2025) is the **fifth iteration** of the framework. The first version was published in 2013, with updates published in 2016, 2017 and 2022.

How is digital competence defined in DigComp?

In DigComp, digital competence is much broader than technical skills. It is defined as knowledge, skills and attitudes for ***the confident, critical and responsible use of, and engagement with, digital technologies for learning, at work, and for participation in society.***

It includes information and data literacy, communication and collaboration, media literacy, digital content creation (including programming), safety (including digital wellbeing and competences related to cybersecurity), intellectual property related questions, problem solving and critical thinking.

Who is DigComp for?

DigComp, already widely used across Europe and internationally, is for **anyone who is interested in understanding and identifying digital competence needs and supporting their development**. This includes policymakers; employers and employment services; researchers and academics; leaders and educators in compulsory and higher education, vocational education and training and lifelong learning; and any individual who is interested in digital competence.

What is DigComp used for?

DigComp enables a **common, shared understanding** of digital competence. It is used in a variety of ways at international, European, national, regional and local levels – for example, to inform digital skills **policies**; to develop digital competence **education and training materials**; to guide the **assessment** of digital competence; or to describe the digital skills for specific jobs or occupations for **recruitment** or **on-the-job training**.

Why and how was DigComp 3.0 developed?

Since the publication of the fourth version of the framework in 2022, significant digital technological developments have taken place. These developments impact on the digital competence needs of individuals, whether for daily life, working, learning, or participating in society.

The DigComp 3.0 update prioritises **Artificial Intelligence** (AI) competence, **cybersecurity** competence, digital **rights**, **choice** and **responsibilities**, **wellbeing** in digital environments, and competences to tackle **mis- and disinformation**. These priorities were identified by looking at recent research and policies, and consulting with experts and stakeholders.

DigComp 3.0 has been developed with the **input of over 300 individuals and organisations** across Europe and beyond, whose work relates in one way or another to digital competence – including policymakers, employers, educators, and researchers.

Before finalising the framework, the JRC consulted with digital competence experts and stakeholders to confirm that DigComp 3.0 is relevant and well-suited to their various needs and uses.

How is the framework organised?

Consistent with previous iterations, DigComp 3.0 describes **five competence areas**. Under each competence area, there are between three and six competences – **21 competences** in all (**Figure 1**). Each competence area and competence is described in detail in the full DigComp 3.0 framework.

For each competence, DigComp 3.0 has **four proficiency levels,** describing progression in individuals' capacities to complete tasks in digital environments. As proficiency progresses, individuals can act more autonomously, and understand and complete tasks that are increasingly complex and cognitively demanding. The level of digital competence that a person needs varies from individual to individual and can change over time (see **Box 1**).

Box 1 – DigComp 3.0 proficiency levels

- At **Basic** level, individuals remember and implement simple tasks with guidance, as needed.
- At **Intermediate** level, they identify and implement well-defined tasks and solve well-defined problems autonomously.
- At **Advanced level,** individuals assess and apply solutions to a variety of complex tasks autonomously and adapt to a variety of contexts to evaluate and execute tasks appropriately, guiding others if and as required.
- At **Highly advanced level**, they assess, evaluate and resolve highly complex or specialised problems to create new solutions or adapt existing ones, leading and guiding others if and as required.

Source: JRC, own elaboration.

What is new in DigComp 3.0?

The DigComp 3.0 update **maintains continuity** with the previous version, DigComp 2.2, **while incorporating changes** that reflect developments in digital technological trends and practices since 2022. **Box 2** summarises the key developments in DigComp 3.0 compared with the previous version.

Figure 1 – DigComp 3.0 competence areas and competences



Source: JRC, own elaboration.

Box 2 – DigComp 3.0 developments compared with DigComp 2.2

a) Updates to the wording of **competence areas** and **competences**
b) Revised **proficiency levels**
c) **New learning outcomes**
d) A transversal **integration of AI competence**
e) An extended **Glossary** that explains the words and terms used
f) **Multiple formats**, for easier tailoring and adaptation of the framework.

Source: JRC, own elaboration.

What are learning outcomes in DigComp 3.0?

Learning outcomes are *short statements of what an individual knows or is able to do after completing a learning process of any kind*. They have been developed in response to users' needs for more clarity in how to apply the framework and **help** the framework to be **interpreted more easily and consistently**.

Learning outcomes are an important **policy and practical tool**, widely used across Europe. They provide a way to recognise and value individuals' competences and all forms of learning. They can be used for a variety of purposes such as developing or revising curricula, education and training material or assessments, defining qualifications, or describing skills needed for a particular job or role.

The full DigComp 3.0 framework contains over 500 learning outcomes, classified by competence (see **Figure 1**) and proficiency level (see **Box 1**).

How has AI competence been integrated into DigComp 3.0?

AI is widely used and is increasingly embedded in existing digital technologies. This gives rise to a need for individuals to understand what AI is, ways in which AI can be used, and their rights and responsibilities for AI's safe and ethical use.

In DigComp 3.0, AI is framed as one digital technology among a range of digital technologies, while keeping the **focus on the digital competences themselves**. AI-related knowledge, skills and attitudes are featured in **all 21 competences** of the framework.

The full DigComp 3.0 framework describes how AI competence has been systematically incorporated.

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CONTACT INFORMATION

European Commission, Joint Research Centre (JRC)
Contact: Judith Cosgrove
E-mail: Judith.Cosgrove@ec.europa.eu

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